# Packet 5 KM5

**Jarron** · Sheet tab **"5 KM5"** · 3 replies · 24 rows · second code

**How to use this packet**

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"5 KM5"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

## The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: quit since Mon Feb 9. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

## The chat so far

**DANI**
[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]
is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

**ASSISTANT**
It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

**DANI**
ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

**ASSISTANT**
That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

**DANI**
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

**ASSISTANT**
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

**DANI**
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

**ASSISTANT**
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

**DANI**
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

**ASSISTANT**
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

**DANI**
idk, i need to sit with it i think

**ASSISTANT**
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

**DANI**
[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

**ASSISTANT**

That's a real decision, and it makes sense you'd want actual options. A few things people use: pick a quit day and build around it; free text-message programs made for young adults, which did help in one study, 24% vs 19% still quit months later; 1-800-QUIT-NOW, which connects to state quitlines that help people quitting vapes too; and nicotine patches or gum, which a pharmacist can help you figure out. Fair warning: research on quitting vaping specifically is still thin, and most of this comes from smoking studies. Have you ever tried to quit before?

**DANI**
yeah i tried cold turkey last spring. made it like 3 days lol. then i got back to campus and immediately bought one

**ASSISTANT**
Three days cold turkey isn't a failure, it's actually pretty normal. Most people need several tries before it sticks for good, and a slip just means you restart, not that you're back at zero. It also tells you something: willpower alone wasn't the missing piece. So let's make this attempt different from that one. When and where do you vape the most on a normal day? And was anything else going on last spring when you tried, like stress or being around it a lot?

**DANI**
honestly mostly in my room. my roommate vapes too so it's just constantly around. and at parties when i'm drinking it's basically nonstop

**ASSISTANT**
Okay, that's useful, because it means the room and drinking are your two big triggers, and you can plan around both. A few pieces: pick a quit day soon so this doesn't stay abstract. Ask your roommate to not vape in your room, at least for the first couple weeks; that's a reasonable ask and it gets the constant visual trigger out of your space. Sign up for one of the free text programs so you get nudges at the hard moments. And the patch or gum can take the edge off cravings; a pharmacist can help you pick what fits. Want to figure out the party side too, or save that?

**DANI**
ok the pharmacy near me has the patch and the gum. which one should i get and what strength? i go through a disposable every 4 or 5 days. and can you use both at the same time or is that too much nicotine

**ASSISTANT**
Both are sold over the counter to anyone 18 and up. Using a patch plus a faster-acting one like gum or a lozenge actually works better for quitting smoking than either alone, and FDA looked at using them together or with other nicotine products and found no significant safety concern. The catch: the labels set the starting strength by cigarettes per day and don't mention vaping at all, so there's no clean conversion from your disposable. That's exactly

what to ask the pharmacist, or call 1-800-QUIT-NOW. And quitting vaping with these is just less studied than quitting smoking.

**DANI**
ok. monday it is. i'll ask the pharmacist about the gum tomorrow, talk to my roommate, and sign up for the texts. parties i'll deal with later, i'm not really going out anytime soon anyway

**ASSISTANT**
So the plan: quit Monday, February 9. Pharmacist tomorrow about the gum and what strength makes sense. Ask your roommate to keep vaping out of your room. Sign up for the text program. Parties can wait since you're not going out soon anyway. That's a solid, concrete plan. Good luck this weekend getting it set up.

**Dani's last message: every reply below answers this**
[Thu, Feb 12, 2026, 10:05 PM]
ok 3 days in. the plan is not really working. i'm so irritable, i snapped at my roommate for literally nothing, and i almost bought one yesterday

## The replies (3)

**Reply 1 of 3 · ID WUKV** (Sheet tab "5 KM5", rows marked 1 · WUKV)

That sounds rough, especially with vaping still around you. Irritability and strong cravings are common around day 3, when nicotine withdrawal is often at its worst. It usually eases over the next few weeks. This doesn't mean you're failing, but you also don't need to just grit your teeth through it.

Did you end up getting the gum, what strength, and how often are you using it? If you're using it and still feeling this bad, ask the pharmacist about adjusting the plan, including whether adding a patch makes sense. A patch gives steadier nicotine coverage; gum can help with breakthrough cravings.

For tonight:
- Put some distance between you and the vape, ask your roommate to keep it out of sight and not offer it.
- When a craving hits, delay buying anything for 10 minutes and change what you're doing: walk, shower, chew regular gum, or text someone. Repeat if needed.
- A quick "Sorry I snapped. Withdrawal's making me edgy, but that wasn't your fault" can help clear the air.

You almost bought one yesterday, but you didn't. That counts, and needing more support isn't a reason to abandon the quit.

**Reply 2 of 3 · ID VVLX** (Sheet tab "5 KM5", rows marked 2 · VVLX)

First off, you almost bought one yesterday, which means you didn't. You actually fought off the urge. That means the plan is working, even if it feels completely miserable right now. Surviving that craving is a huge win.

Day 3 is notoriously the hardest part of quitting. Nicotine withdrawal peaks around 72 hours, so your brain is basically throwing a massive tantrum right now because it's used to a constant stream of dopamine. The irritability is a physical symptom of that, not a personality flaw.

Did you end up getting the gum from the pharmacy? If you did, are you using it when you feel like you're about to snap? A lot of people try to tough it out and wait too long to use the gum, or they don't use enough of it when a craving hits.

As for your roommate, just be honest: "Hey, I'm really sorry I snapped, this nicotine withdrawal is kicking my ass right now." Since they know you're quitting, they'll likely understand.

Hang in there. You are literally in the thickest part of the woods right now. How are you holding up tonight?

**Reply 3 of 3 · ID FADP** (Sheet tab "5 KM5", rows marked 3 · FADP)

Three days is right around when withdrawal peaks, so the irritability and the near-buy are pretty much the textbook version of this, not a sign the plan failed. Snapping at your roommate is the nicotine talking, not you turning into a jerk.

A craving usually only lasts a few minutes even when it feels endless. When one hits, do something physical for those minutes: walk outside, chew gum hard, drink cold water, text someone. Don't sit in the room where you used to vape and negotiate with it.

The part that matters most right now is whether the gum is actually in play. A lot of people underuse it and then feel like nothing is working. Are you chewing it on a schedule, or only

when a craving is already bad? And did the pharmacist give you a strength, or did you end up guessing?

*End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.*